The TISSI Tour

20

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Forget the LIV, PGA and DP World tours, we all know that the BDT is THE most important global golf tour. Indeed the tour rules provide that attending another golf tour is a serious breach of the tour rules and several Dogs have faced severe consequences at the OC as a result.

The rule is hardly needed as, by and large, the group has stayed very loyal and few would even consider joining a rebel tour. Sadly, one of our group was persuaded to join what is known as the "TISSI" tour, TISSI apparently standing for: "Trans-Iberian Social Spoon Invitational". Whatever.

There was a time back in the day when we would all have to endure Ash's chat about TISSI-this and TISSI-that, what a set of "players" they all were, in a different league to us Dogs etc etc – YAWN!



One Tour Jacket Ash Has Worn!



Dual Towels – A DISGRACE!!





Scarcely Believable Photos!

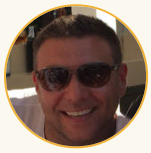
These lads would rock up at a Chewbacca Challenge full of themselves and with nothing but disparaging comments about the BDT, calling us childish names such as the Little Puppies and The Poodles. Shocking. Valid questions were being asked of Ash as to which tour he really belonged to as the suspicion was that, behind closed doors, he was not entirely supportive of us.

It would be fair to say that most of these characters would simply not go down well at an OC! They would need taking down several pegs. So when Boggy offered us the opportunity to take them down at a Celtic Manor match-up we jumped at the chance to put aside Bloodhound vs Retriever rivalries to team together to do just that in 2010.

It was pleasing to report that not only did we demolish them on the course, but we also completely obliterated them off it. When push came to shove, compared with us tour veterans they were a bunch of amateurs, setting off at a Purling-Night-One-Of-Tour pace only to fade extremely rapidly as the evening progressed. We took them into some of Cardiff's finest hostelries and despite all the Larry-Large chat (and there was bucketloads of it!) they capitulated early doors.

That year's results are set out below and to this day the combined Retriever / Bloodhounds pairings just don't look quite right! Here is the 2010 match report from The Monkey.

The 2010 Match Report
James Hurst


HURSTY

"Following many weeks of meticulous preparation from the BDT Captain, Barry Chuckle, both teams arrived for the eagerly awaited tournament just in time for the opening ceremony at 1pm. This was where the BDT unfortunately took an early low blow as the TISSI boys were all dressed in matching blazers, shirts and trousers whilst we all looked slightly mis-matched in our tour stash. Particularly Ravo who had managed to lose his first Retriever jersey. 1-0 TISSI.


The TISSI Team



The Combined Big Dogs Team

What also became immediately apparent was that these boys had the edge in the looks and youth stats (save for the two dads who made up the numbers), which gave us the added incentive to take 'em down!

The respective captains announced the two teams and it was at this point that we all became slightly confused (similar to when Oli G announced his team in Girona) by the opposition's banter / humour! Whilst Neil announced his players by reference to previous tour nicknames, all of their players were known by their initials in the same vein as we refer to BT and DT.

It's fine having two, but bloody difficult to keep track of who's who when they are all being referred to as RB, DF, RC, PHD, CE etc etc!! This ritual continued throughout the entirety of our stay and even now I struggle to remember any of them! Rob Barry did tell me on the 4th that it was a public schoolboy thing and I probably wouldn't understand!

The format of the day was fourball better ball for the front nine and singles for the back with a total of 12 points on offer.

There were clearly a few nerves on the practice range as the Dogs started spraying to all angles of the valley but as the announcer welcomed the Tour President onto the first tee it was game on. Paddy and Ash both down the middle, TISSI in trouble off the tee, and we were under way!

The 2010 course was in immaculate condition and as we turned at the halfway hut the BDT were firmly in control winning the fourballs 3-1.

The Big Dog TISSI Trophy Celtic Manor - 2010 Front Nine - Fourball Better Ball				
	Big Dogs		TISSI	
Won 1UP	Paddy MDE & Ash	v	Graham Townsend & Terry Barry	
Won 3&1	Hursty & Buzz	v	Robert Barry & David Foreman	
	Ravo & Langrish	v	John Chambers & Robert Thompson	Won 3&2
Won 3&2	Boggy & Oli G	v	Paul Harris & Chris Evans	
Fourballs Score	3		1	Fourballs Score

Front Nine Scorecard

It was at this stage that I thought a little Heineken would go down well with my sausage sandwich. That it did, but unfortunately my next drive off the Par 5 11th managed to travel all of 2 yards leaving me with a most difficult second off the tee bed (with shorts dropped)! Thankfully Langrish followed suit not long afterwards...



Trousers Down

Despite a mighty effort from our younger, less experienced opposition to claw things back, it was just too much of a lead and the BDT ran out comfortable winners 8.5 - 3.5.

The Big Dog TISSI Trophy Celtic Manor - 2010 Back Nine - Singles				
Big Dogs			TISSI	
Won 2&1	Paddy MDE	v	Graham Townsend	
Won 4&3	Ash	v	Terry Barry	
A/S	Hursty	v	David Foreman	A/S
Won 2UP	Buzz	v	Robert Barry	
A/S	Ravo	v	John Chambers	A/S
	Langrish	v	Richard Thompson	Won 2UP
Won 4&2	Oli G	v	Paul H	
A/S	Boggy	v	Chris Evans	A/S
Singles Score	5½		2½	Singles Score
Overall Score	8½		3½	Overall Score

Back Nine Scorecard

Richard Thompson was named MVP for TISSI after amassing 2 points out of 2 and scoring a virtually level par round by all accounts! Big Bad Buzz was awarded the MVD for the Big Dogs after also winning 2 points out of 2 and shooting 22 points on his front nine.





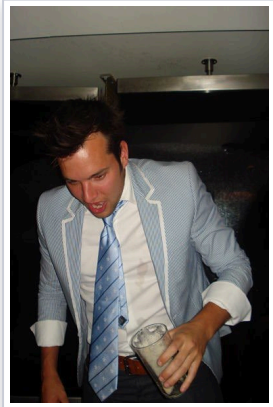


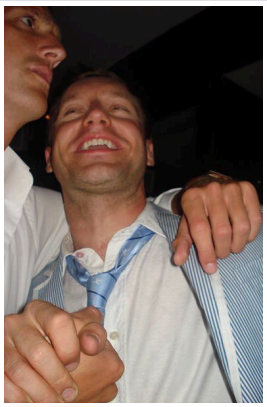


Celtic Manor Memories

All was not lost however for the TISSI boys as it was clear that they fancied their chances in the second activity of the day, the drinking. We all know that the Dogs should never be underestimated in this department!

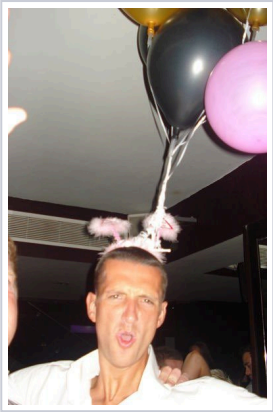
The chosen establishment for the evening was Tiger Tiger where all 16 of us set about the evening's entertainment with pace and strength. It's fair to say that the TISSI boys showed their slight inexperience here, yet all the Dogs were most impressed with the aggressive manner in which they set about downing pints and ordering crazy drinks such as black sambuca and Jäger bombs before dinner. Approximately two hours later, three of their boys had puked and the others were well on their way!











Ruined TISSI Members

What was also very interesting about this early display of aggression was the speed in which Ash managed to drink two pints in one. Never ever has this been witnessed on a BDT and we all agreed that he was just showing off in front of his new tour buddies and proving that he would be able to live with them later in the year.



Ash Impressing His New Mates!

Having moved from the dinner table to the bar the pace became even more relentless as all forms of spirits, alcopops and other concoctions made an appearance. The sight of CE (think that's what they call him) strolling around the room with a bottle of vodka was certainly special. The bouncers obviously didn't agree and at some stage ejected the poor lad.

After throwing ourselves around the room to 'Don't Stop Believing' and 'Tonight's Gonna Be A Good Night', we turned round at 3.30am to realise that the squad of 16 had now diminished to a squad of 8. There wasn't a TISSI blazer or tie in sight yet 8 dogs remained, standing tall and ready for more. After a brief spell in another club (of the non-lapper variety), we all returned home en masse, a proud team that had just battered our opponents both on and off the course!!!



TISSI Demolished!

In the following days, as the stories started to flow from what happened to our TISSI friends, it turns out that they were all ejected from TT, some visited the Fantasy Lounge whilst others trudged around Cardiff City Centre continuing to swig neat vodka. The culmination of the evening was the TISSI captain arriving back to Celtic Manor at 5am with a police escort but without cash, phone and wallet (we've all been there!). Many thanks to Neil for organising a fantastic day and to the TISSI boys for their banter and sportsmanship.

Hursty"

The TISSI boys did not take defeat well and pestered us for a re-match, which Hursty announced would take place on Friday 21 March 2014 at Worplesdon GC per the following email.

The 2014 Re-Match
James Hurst



HURSTY

"Gentlemen,

Following Ash's house party on Saturday night (where BT, myself and Little were well outnumbered by TISSI amateurs) it was decided that 4 years on from the inaugural match, it was time for the second match to be played. It has been almost 4 years since the inaugural BDT v TISSI match took place and it's time to do battle again.

There has been plenty of chat about which tour is the best blah blah blah and this is the opportunity to score appropriate bragging rights from a golfing, drinking and general banter perspective!

The two teams are lining up as follows:

BDT	TISSI
James Hurst (Captain)	RB - Robert Barry
Fred Doyhamboure	WG - Will Grant
Brendan Taylor	DF - David Foreman
Anthony Knox	JC - John Chambers
Ashley Hurst (was a tough call but TISSI didn't want him)	DS - David Seddon
Ciaran Little	RT - Richard Thompson
Mark Clarkson	AP - Alex Partakis
Greg Boyes	CS – Chris Seddon

We are playing at Worplesdon Golf Club in Surrey and the tee is reserved from 10.00am. The format as per the first match will be 8 v 8 with the first 9 holes being fourballs and the back nine singles for a total of 12 points.

Bacon Butts will be served from 9am so I suggest you get down there around then. In terms of transport, there will be a bus leaving south west London so contact RT if you wanna get involved with this.

The total cost per head is £65.00 which includes golf, bacon butts and lunch which believe me, is a bargain.

We will be terrorising south west London in the evening so tell your Mrs (those who have one) that you'll see them on Saturday morning.

There is no strict dress code as I have no doubt this is the only department where the Tissi boys may outshine us!

These boys really do think they are a level above us in all fields both on and off the course. We proved them wrong in 2010, and we shall do so again.

Looking forward to it.

Hursty"

The pairings were as follows:

BT & Boysie

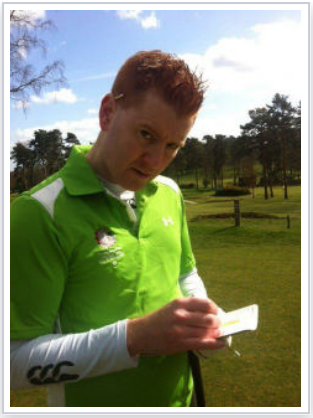
Hursty & Harbo

Ash & Knoxy

Little & Buzz



Worplesdon Action



Quizzical Little



Thumbs Up Buzz



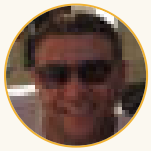
Ash with his TISSI Mates!

Once again, the Big Dogs TOOK THEM DOWN! This despite an inauspicious start from Hursty who hit one of the all-time greatest opening gambits!



▶ **Watch:** Monkey Top!

A post match email from Hursty shows that the BDT won by 8.5 points to TISSI's 3.5 points:



HURSTY

"Another resounding victory, with 2 points for Buzz and Boysie and 1.5 points for Knoxy. I am pleased to report that Neilan, Clarkson and Hurst were last to be seen in Maddox at 4am. Not a TISSI in sight. Comprehensive victory once again. The highlight so far was when our opposition found out Knoxy's handicap at 37! Also, Buzz could be dangerous on BDT 2014!"

The TISSI lads' chat can be seen in some post-match emails as below:

"TISSI / Mini (Flea Bitten) Poodles,

A superbly social evening, indeed...well done to RT for his organisational skills sorting the pub venue etc, Hursty for his warm up act as chairman, Ashley for his "super lawyer" expertise available via BlackBerry to clients throughout the evening, moreover to DS and DF (aka Kim Jong Un) for running the main part of the evening with a great fines and 21s circle - v funny.

Vague memories of.....to my left; 1 2 TISSI losers, tiny poodles, woof, ITWT, 7, 8, 9 woof, bloodhounds, 12, 13, 14, woof...then it all gets slightly blurred.... (corrections may be required).

It's fair to say if it was possible to combine the Poodles v impressive golf performances, loyal values, team spirit and (bandit territory) handicaps, with our superiority in boozing / 21s game play, overall dress code and youthful looks...Carlsberg and the world over would witness a seriously potent tour group!

Maybe sort a rematch (ie. USA trip) within 2 years, or for those keen on another mixer a little sooner - Bunga Bunga tonight: maybe see you in there! KIS*

RB *Keep It Social."

"Chaps,

Well played to the Big Dogs, good golf as always and a very sociable day all round.

Big thanks to JH for arranging Worplesdon and I certainly can't take any responsibility for the pub - JH again. Brilliant set up. Sterling job from DS sorting post meal activities.

I would certainly support a yearly match, the week before the first major might be great timing. I'd personally prefer to play the comp over two rounds and with enough notice I'm sure it could be arranged pretty efficiently.

I'll look forward to the Big Dogs match report...and RB's match report. Fairly sure one will be significantly longer than the other!

Cheers,

RT"

"Echo all of this. Great day, great night, and thanks to all.

We, again, were owned on the course, though reclaimed some credibility in the post-golf activities.

I can only assume internal disciplinary proceedings will ensue at BDT HQ; the episode in which said poodle refused to do a number of fines, before three TISSI members stepped up to consume 1x IPA (CS), 2x tumblers of red wine (JC), 1x Guinness (RB) was telling.

(Said poodle knows who he is, and I'll save further public embarrassment... I'm sure this can be dealt with in Marbella on a charge of bringing the tour into disrepute).

JC x"

"Said poodle" was Little, of course!



The Victorious Big Dogs!

Thankfully Ash's TISSI chat has largely disappeared these days and he seems to have come to his senses in realising that there really is only one tour that matters, as evidenced by this video footage from Celtic Manor. Let's hope the TISSI tourists never chance upon this....!!



▶ **Watch:** The TISSI Tour is nothing compared to this!!